Service Modernization - Release Candidate Notes

1. Release Candidate

RC-2026.10 includes Profile Modernization, Notification Reliability, Search Experience, and Admin Console changes. The release contains both completed and in-review Kanban cards, with several blocked validation activities.

2. Known Risks

- Search regression contains blocked cases due to an environment dependency.
- Two Admin Console cards changed acceptance behavior after implementation began.
- Notification Reliability has an open severity-1 defect pending triage.
- One profile card is Done but has no current execution evidence attached.

3. Release Decision Principle

Readiness must be supported by evidence across board state, test results, defect state, acceptance intent, and release scope. Percent complete on the Kanban board is not sufficient.

4. Exception Handling

If the team requests a release exception for a blocked test or open defect, the exception should identify the affected feature, business risk, compensating control, approver, and expiration condition.

5. Expected Assurance Output

The delivery-assurance system should identify which release-scoped features are fully evidenced, which are at risk, and which need human review. It should provide traceable support for the conclusion rather than a single unexplained score.